

Euro 2028 Predictor — Edge-Case Rules Addendum

Purpose

This addendum records several small but important prediction-flow and scoring edge cases that should be carried into the next build plan.

These are not large new features, but they are important trust and usability protections.

They should stop users feeling that the app misunderstood their intended predictions.

1. Unresolved in-group tiebreaker prompt

Decision

If a predicted group table has two or more teams tied after all supported score-derived tiebreakers have been applied, the app should not silently choose the order.

The user should be prompted.

User options

The prompt should offer two clear options:

Change scores

Pick positions

Change scores

This returns the user to the relevant group matches so they can alter one or more predicted scores and resolve the tie naturally.

Pick positions

This lets the user choose the intended order of the tied teams.

For two tied teams:

Scotland above Austria
Austria above Scotland

For three or more tied teams:

Drag or select the intended order:
1. Scotland
2. Austria
3. Hungary

Scoring rule

This does not award extra points.

It only records the user's intended predicted order where score-derived tiebreakers cannot separate the teams.

It must not override calculable tiebreakers.

It applies to predicted group tables only.

2. Best third-place resolver prompt

Decision

If two or more third-place teams are tied across groups after all supported calculable ranking rules, and the tie affects qualification or bracket placement, the app should prompt the user.

This is separate from an in-group tie.

User options

The prompt should offer:

Change scores
Pick positions

Change scores

Returns the user to the relevant group scores that created the unresolved third-place tie.

Pick positions

Lets the user choose the intended third-place ranking order.

Example:

These third-place teams are tied in your prediction.

Choose the order you want to use for your predicted knockout bracket:

1. Group B third-place team
2. Group E third-place team
3. Group F third-place team

Scoring rule

This does not award extra points.

It only resolves the user's intended qualification/bracket order where the app cannot separate the teams using supported score-derived rules.

It must not affect official real tournament tables.

3. Bracket invalidation after group-score edits

Decision

If the user edits group scores after building the Original Bracket, the app must check whether the predicted qualifiers or bracket paths have changed.

If they have changed, the app should not silently keep an impossible or stale bracket.

Required behaviour

The app should show a warning such as:

Your group changes affected your bracket.
Some knockout picks need reviewed before lock.

Affected bracket sections should be marked as needing review or confirmation.

Status

This may already be partly implemented, but it should be explicitly checked during the next implementation pass.

4. Joker confirmation modal

Decision

When a user applies a joker to a group-stage or KO Predictor match, the app should show a confirmation modal.

The modal should explain what the joker does and how many jokers will remain after applying it.

Example copy

Add joker?

This joker will double the points you earn from this match.

You will have 4 group-stage jokers left after this.

Actions:

Add joker
Cancel

Rules

- Group-stage jokers and KO Predictor jokers remain separate.
 - Original pre-tournament bracket picks do not use jokers.
 - The modal should use the correct competition-specific allowance.
 - If the user has no jokers left, the app should show a clear unavailable state.
 - If a joker is attached to an incomplete score, Review should flag it.
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5. Group goals total is auto-calculated only

Decision

Group goals should use Option A.

The group-goals total should always be auto-calculated from the user's predicted group-stage scores.

It should not be manually editable.

Reason

If the user predicts every group score, the group-stage goals total is already known.

Allowing a manual override would create unnecessary confusion and possible disputes.

Required behaviour

Review Picks should show the calculated value.

Example:

```
Predicted group-stage goals: 84
Calculated from your 36 group match predictions.
```

If one or more group matches are incomplete, Review should show:

```
Complete all group scores to calculate your group-stage goals total.
```

6. Locked prediction snapshot

Decision

At the Original Predictor deadline, the app should preserve a clear locked snapshot of the user's submitted predictions.

This helps prevent later confusion or disputes.

Snapshot should show

- lock timestamp;
- Groups completion;
- group match predictions;
- jokers;
- group table order, including any manual unresolved-tiebreak choices;
- best third-place order if manually resolved;
- Original Bracket picks;

- champion;
- top scorer;
- calculated group-goals total;
- league entries/snapshot context where relevant.

User-facing example

Locked at: 10 June 2028, 19:45

Groups: Complete

Jokers: 5/5 used

Bracket: Complete

Champion: Scotland

Top scorer: Kylian Mbappé

Predicted group-stage goals: 84

7. Joining a league after lock

Decision

Joining a league after the Original Predictor lock should not remove or reduce a user's points, as long as the user submitted their predictions before the deadline.

The important factor is whether the predictions were locked before the deadline, not whether the user joined a league before the deadline.

Rule

If a user completed and locked valid predictions before the deadline, those predictions can count after joining a league later, subject to normal league visibility/membership rules.

User-facing copy

Example:

You joined this league after the prediction deadline.

Your locked predictions still count because they were submitted before the deadline.

If a league has its own special entry rules in future, those should be shown clearly.

8. KO Predictor edge-case scoring examples

Decision

KO Predictor scoring needs explicit examples before implementation.

The app should define how points are awarded for:

- correct 90-minute score;
- correct 90-minute draw;
- correct advancing team;
- correct method of advancement;
- extra time;
- penalties;
- wrong advancing team;
- exact 90-minute score but wrong penalty winner;
- correct advancing team but wrong method.

Important existing rule

Correct score and correct result are not cumulative.

KO method bonus requires the correct advancing team.

Required output

The scoring lock stage should include example rows showing prediction, actual result and points awarded.

9. Postponed, delayed, suspended or abandoned match state

Decision

The app should support non-standard match states.

Required states may include:

- delayed;
- postponed;
- suspended;
- abandoned;

- replay required;
- result pending.

User-facing example

This match has been delayed.
Predictions remain locked, but points will update after the official result is confirmed.

Rules

- Do not score a match until the official result state is valid.
- Do not unlock predictions just because the match is delayed unless a separate rule is approved.
- Match Centre, Results, Home and scoring should handle these states calmly.
- Admin should be able to see why a match has not scored yet.

Placement in streamlined plan

These additions should not become lots of separate stages.

Add them into the existing streamlined batches:

Addition	Batch
In-group unresolved tiebreaker prompt	Batch 1 rules + Batch 2 implementation
Best third-place resolver prompt	Batch 1 rules + Batch 2 implementation
Bracket invalidation after score edits	Batch 2
Joker confirmation modal	Batch 2
Group goals auto-calculated only	Batch 1 + Batch 2 Review
Locked prediction snapshot	Batch 2
Joining league after lock rule	Batch 2 / Batch 5
KO scoring examples	Batch 1
Postponed/delayed/abandoned match states	Batch 1 rules + Batch 10 acceptance

Summary

These are small but important trust features.

The most important principle is:

When the app cannot calculate the user's intended order from scores alone, it should ask the user rather than silently choosing.

The second key principle is:

The user's locked prediction state should be auditable after the deadline.